GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

January 9th, 2026
Week 2
Volume 280, Issue 1218

Highlights:

- **Constant shocks.**
- **US threats.**
- **India volatile.**
- **Pre CNY buying.**
- **Around 400.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Make sure your worst enemy doesn't live between your own two ears."

– Laird Hamilton

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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TAUT WITH TENSIONS!

If 2026 continues as it has started, we are more than likely in for another roller-coaster year full of geopolitical risks, tensions, aggravations, and increasingly frequent shocks that could affect the shipping and ship recycling industries in numerous — and as yet untold — ways.

Trump's kidnapping (let's call it what it is) of President Maduro and his wife from Venezuela — followed by U.S. claims that it will "run" the country when Trump can't even handle the U.S. — has already set the tone for the madness we can expect in 2026. Amping up the octogenarian crankiness, he also threatened to take Greenland as a U.S. territory this week, drawing swift condemnation from Russia, China, and even senior Congressional Republicans on Capitol Hill, who confirmed that Congress would never agree to such overtly aggressive actions on behalf of the U.S. The subsequent capture of a Russian-controlled oil tanker carrying Venezuelan oil sent further shocks through the industry, raising the question of which other wild move this administration is willing to inflict on the world.

Markets reacted as they always do i.e. with chaos and volatility. The Baltic Exchange reported another bleak week of declines for the fifth straight Friday, falling about 1.7%, dragged down by capes (down 3%) and supramaxes (down 9 points), while panamaxes jumped about 0.7% by Friday's close. Oil meanwhile managed to rise just about USD 59.50/barrel, extending its gain for a third consecutive session.

Currencies went on a tear once again, with the U.S. Dollar inflicting pain in Turkey and India (once again), while retreating in the Pakistani and Bangladeshi markets. Last week's reported increase in local steel plate prices was also met with declining levels, even though the weekly moves might suggest otherwise — as current pricing remains lower than where it stood two weeks ago.

Trickling down to the ship recycling sector, while India has enjoyed a resurgent start to the year on the back of local steel plate prices that jumped nearly USD 30/Ton, this week saw local sentiment turning negative again as plate levels retreated just as rapidly. Pakistan and Bangladesh meanwhile responded in kind with improved demand and pricing of their own as activity starts to seemingly heat up ahead of the inevitable slowdown for Chinese New Year at the end of January into February and Far Eastern tonnage typically takes another break from Bangla waters. Local deliveries also showed marginal improvement, with just a couple of candidates making it to sub-continent anchorages this week.

As such, after the end-of-2025 decline in pricing, owners with vintage tonnage and surveys due may look to test the market again as levels hover around the USD 400/LDT mark, which are still strong – all things considered.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 2 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

TAILS UP!

Price return.

After the stark declines towards the tail-end of Q4 2025 followed by vanishing demand and collapsing local offerings that saw Chattogram choppers land at the bottom of the market rankings just last week, signs of life and recovery emerged locally this week

However, with the wild performance of India's fundamentals and dithering local sentiments there, demand in Bangladesh started to firm, despite political uncertainty reportedly reaching a feverous pitch amidst tensions and outbreaks of violence continue, with the nation's critical elections now just about a month away. Moreover, following the recent death of the first female PM to run the country and the assassination of a youth leader — both within weeks — episodes of violent protest engulfed Bangladesh in the aftermath, leaving many hoping for a more serene and orderly election process ahead.

Political problems.

Locally, the still-deflated level of supply saw just one fresh vessel arrive and make its way to delivery, alongside all of the units that arrived the week prior, leaving Chattogram's anchorage dead as the week ended. This cross-border see-saw — which saw empty anchorages in Alang and Gadani just last week — may soon see Chattogram tie the competition with a likely empty anchorage of its own in the coming week(s).

LC hold up.

Several L/Cs were meanwhile held up over the recent tide due to a change in personnel at the Central Bank in Dhaka, with additional documentary requirements introduced since the change to push these L/Cs through. For the most part, however, the fact that Chattogram's anchorage is now empty, indicates that local deliveries did manage to pull through.

Fundamentals meanwhile remain frail, as the Taka gained a mere nine basis points against the U.S. Dollar and walked out the Friday door at BDT 122.26. Local steel plate prices, on the other hand, finally started trading once again and opened mid-week around USD 500/ton — not the best place to be, but still not as grim as India, which is nearly USD 100/ton lower and yet continues to outbid Bangladesh at the tables.

Full stomach.

Clearly, no one locally wants to eat on a full stomach.

If local recyclers don't make it back into the fray by end of Monday, it seems all will be quiet locally — at least until elections conclude.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

QUICK REVERSE!

After what seemed to be some serious improvements in local steel plate prices post-New Year in India — with levels jumping nearly USD 30/ton last week, this week, they opened USD 6/ton lower than last and ended up wiping out all of the recent gains, sliding back down to USD 400/ton once again. Not wanting to be outdone, the Rupee chased the U.S. Dollar as it lost another 20 basis points this week and closed at Rs. 90.21.

Steel slide.

Given that Alang buyers tend to be a nervy bunch, sentiment has weakened, and end buyers have become more cautious about being boisterous with their offers, for fear of further falls ahead — particularly amid the global political and economic uncertainty besetting markets at present. At the same time, a USD 30/ton swing in the core pricing mechanism of recycling vessels is not something to be scoffed at.

Weakened.

Mercifully, tonnage supply remains weak, so these expectedly lower indications are unlikely to lead anywhere in the interim. But even as supply remains thin, India did manage to crawl out of "empty anchorage" syndrome as at least one 2,500 LDT vessel greeted the waterfront last week, with another two reportedly waiting to come in.

Notwithstanding, sustained performance — and a bit of courage — will be needed in Alang for recyclers to secure their share of any market tonnage that becomes available, especially as Pakistan and Bangladesh warm up to negotiating at the tables again, albeit with Bangladesh potentially in for a short nap until election day.

v needed.

Short nap.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

INTO THE BREACH!

Seeking to buy.

Pakistan has been looking to get back into the action since the start of the year, with enquiries emerging from buyers whose yards are in the process of being upgraded to HKC standards. However, local offerings have (as has been the trend over the last 2.5 decades from this market) remained just behind those of India, and more aggressive posturing will be needed to secure tonnage and fill local plots again — especially given that local fundamentals remain a breath of fresh air compared to the competition, with both the PKR and local steel plate prices displaying far more stability across the region.

DASR stopgap.

Not only did local steel plate prices firm by about USD 6/ton this week, they also closed the week out at USD 585/ton — USD 185/ton higher than India and an USD 85/ton margin over Bangladesh. It certainly seems as though Iranian imports may have eased off the brakes for now, given Iran's own domestic upheaval at present. At the same time, the Pakistani Rupee gained seven basis points against the U.S. Dollar and closed the week at PKR 280.12 — inching its way back toward the PKR 279s.

With so much financial artillery in Gadani's possession, it was shocking to see the market end last year with just 202 total vessel s delivered locally. Seemingly this year — this poor waterfront performance seems likely to continue especially as HKC yards remain scarce and provisional DASR certifications (issued while HKC upgrade work continues) remain a barrier to fresh inflows. This has left the market barren at the waterfront, and for the second week in a row in 2026, Gadani's anchorage ended the week on an empty note.

Supply hopes.

Speaking of inflow, with the supply of tonnage expected to increase in 2026, Pakistan ship recyclers need to be ready — and willing — to step into the breach at meaningful numbers, with certified yards in place, in order to fill plots and secure their share of the recycling action.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

More zzzzz!

Need some logic.

Aliaga's ship recycling sector seems to have gone into winter hibernation, with little noteworthy news emerging other than the ever-degrading Turkish lira, which lost another 23 basis points this week and closed at TRY 43.14 against the U.S. Dollar.

While local deliveries have remained lower than those seen in Pakistan, it is not for a want of tonnage, but rather the need for a more logical application of EU laws so businesses do not suffocate under media pressure and NGO scrutiny. However, with the sub-continent now formally operating under the HKC, it remains to be seen whether any knock-on changes will be forthcoming for Aliaga in 2026.

If the last five years are any indication — and especially if the lira continues to slip — local offers will continue to fall, and EOL vessel values will ultimately fetch even less for the banks who have mortgaged assets out. What happens then?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 2 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	390 / LDT	410 / LDT	420 / LDT
3	India	**Declining**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

WOWZA!!

- *The winners of the Academy Award for Best Cinematography from 2011 to 2013 were all 3-D movies.*
- *Some veterinarians recommend sunscreening pets—especially light-colored dogs.*
- *An army of robot dogs inspects cars in a Georgia Hyundai factory.*
- *There might not be enough fruits and vegetables in the world to allow the American food industry to switch entirely to natural dyes.*
- *The United States' first-ever racially integrated baseball league for women will begin playing in the spring of 2026.*
- *There are an estimated 25,000 city-killer-size asteroids in near-Earth orbits and just under half have been found.*
- *In 1972, about one in five people who died in the U.S. received an autopsy. That rate has since dropped below one in 10.*
- *The word cooties initially referred to lice and other biting insects that American soldiers encountered during World War I.*
- *An ALS outbreak in a tiny French town may have been caused by wild mushrooms.*
- *Eggs are naturally seasonal.*
- *Because oranges from different regions can taste so different, orange-juice manufacturers blend batches of juice to maintain a consistent flavor profile, much like wine and whiskey makers do.*
- *In the 19th and early 20th centuries, so-called patent medicines sometimes contained explosives.*
- *The Baader 632 Thigh Filleting System can process 230 chicken thighs a minute.*
- *Fertility problems in men can often be overcome by treating a female partner, even if she doesn't have any fertility problems of her own.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
January 14 – Pongal January 26 – Republic Day	January 17 – January 24 January 30 – February 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No Holidays in January	January 21 – January 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
No more holidays in January	**No more holidays in January**

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ALANG - Port Position as of January 09, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Emano 11	2,556	General Cargo	Arrived January 02
Morality		**2,556**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of January 09, 2026

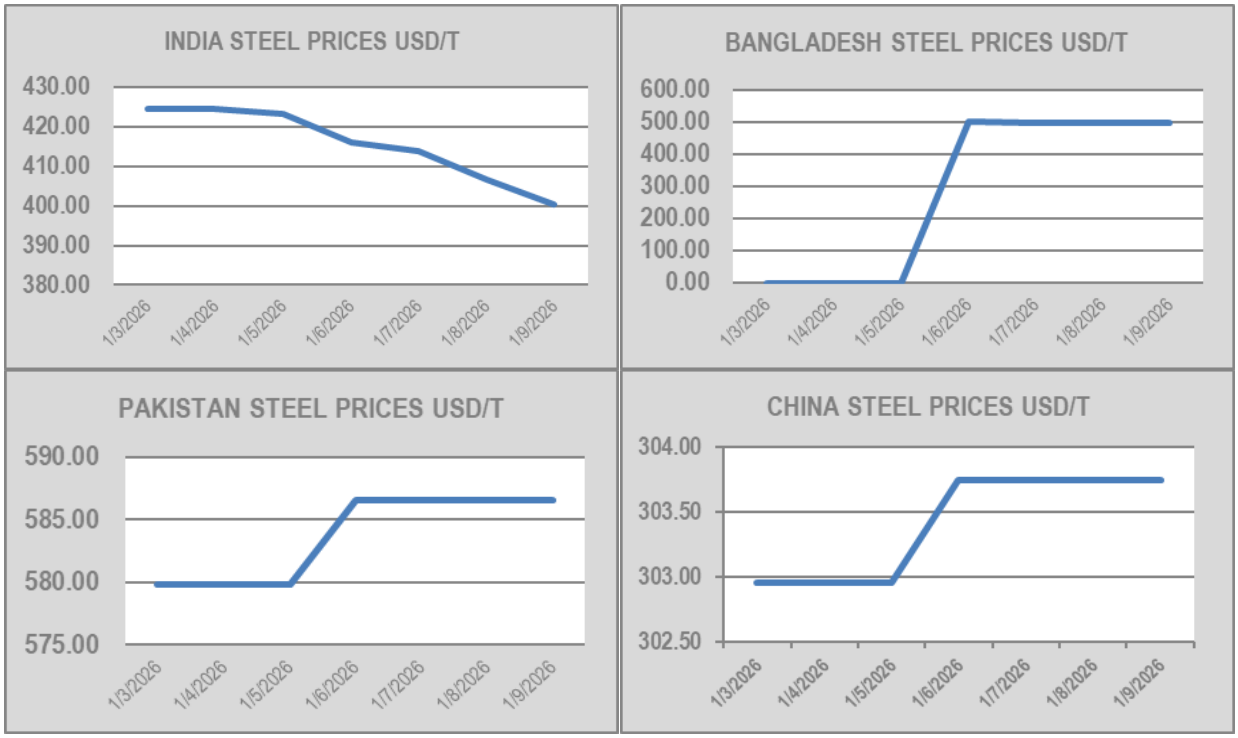
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Gold Origin*	*2,486*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered January 07*
2	*K Asia*	*29,686*	*LNG / Gas Carrier*	*Delivered January 05*
3	*Victor*	*6,086*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered January 07*
4	*Vigo*	*1,302*	*Tanker*	*Delivered January 09*
		39,560		

GADANI - Port Position as of January 09, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
1/3/2026	424.61	38,300.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	302.96
1/4/2026	424.61	38,300.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	302.96
1/5/2026	423.13	38,200.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	302.96
1/6/2026	415.88	37,500.00	586.56	165,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.75
1/7/2026	413.89	37,200.00	586.56	165,000.00	499.59	60,700.00	303.75
1/8/2026	406.58	36,600.00	586.56	165,000.00	499.59	60,700.00	303.75
1/9/2026	400.35	36,100.00	586.56	165,000.00	499.59	60,700.00	303.75



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